NearBNB

MVP Client Scope & Final Product Requirements

Client-facing scope document | MVP baseline | Australia-first, multi-country ready

Purpose: This document describes what will be included in the NearBNB MVP after development. It focuses on product scope and user-visible capabilities rather than implementation details.

1. Product Overview

NearBNB will be a web-based accommodation marketplace connecting guests, hosts and platform administrators. The MVP will support the complete core journey: a host becomes approved and active, publishes a property and bookable category, a guest finds availability, requests a booking for a flexible check-in time, the host accepts or rejects the request, the guest pays, the stay takes place, the host receives a payout, and both sides can review the completed stay.

The initial launch will be Australia-first, but the product will be designed so additional countries, currencies, tax rules, fees and payment/payout configurations can be added later without redesigning the core product.

2. MVP Scope

Area	Included in MVP
Guest	Registration, email verification, profile, property search, availability, booking requests, payment, bookings, cancellation, receipts, reviews and basic issue reporting.
Host	Registration, host application, verification, Stripe payout setup, property management, category/sub-listing management, availability, booking requests, bookings, earnings, transactions, refunds requests and reviews.
Admin	Host approval, property/listing approval, user management, booking management,

	payments, refunds, payouts, reviews, configuration and audit history.
Booking	Request-to-book model with temporary time-slot holds and exact timestamp availability.
Duration	24-hour multiples only: 24, 48, 72 hours and so on.
Check-in	Flexible check-in time using configured time intervals; initial recommendation is 30-minute intervals.
Payments	Guest payment through Stripe.
Host payouts	Stripe Connect-based host payouts with configurable release timing; initial recommendation is 24 hours after check-in.
Reviews	Guest-to-host/property and host-to-guest reviews after a completed stay.
Disputes	Complex dispute-management workflow is outside MVP; basic issue/reporting support may be provided.

3. Guest Features

- Create an account and verify the email address.
- Complete and manage the guest profile.
- Search properties by location and booking requirements.
- View property and category/sub-listing details.
- View pricing and applicable fees/taxes.
- Open an availability view to understand when the selected category is available or occupied.
- Select a flexible check-in date and time.
- Select a stay duration in 24-hour multiples only.
- Submit a booking request.
- Pay after the host accepts the booking request.
- View confirmed and past bookings.
- Cancel a booking according to the applicable cancellation policy.
- View payment receipts and refund status.
- Review the host/property after the stay is completed.
- Raise a basic issue/report when required.

4. Host Features

- Create a normal NearBNB account.
- Apply to become a host.
- Complete the required host identity/verification process.
- Connect a Stripe account for payouts.
- Become an active host only after the required approval/verification and Stripe payout setup conditions are satisfied.
- Create and manage properties.
- Create separate bookable categories/sub-listings such as Standard, Premium or Pool.
- Set the price for each category/sub-listing.
- Manage availability for each category/sub-listing.
- Submit properties/listings for administrator approval.
- Receive booking requests for their own properties.
- Accept or reject booking requests.
- View guest information according to the booking visibility rules.
- Manage their own reservations.
- View their own payment/transaction/refund/earning information.
- Request an exceptional refund through the platform when necessary.
- View payout status and payout history.
- Review guests after completed stays.
- Report guest/property issues to the platform.

5. Admin Features

- Admin login and secure admin profile management.
- Review, approve, reject or request changes to host applications.
- Review, approve, reject or request changes to property/listing submissions.
- Suspend/reactivate hosts and guests.
- Manage users and view their relevant account/booking history.
- View and manage all bookings across the platform.
- View platform-wide payments, refunds and payouts.
- Process or approve exceptional refunds.
- Manage platform fees and commissions.
- Manage applicable cancellation policies and other agreed business settings.
- Manage categories/sub-listing configuration where platform-wide configuration is required.
- Moderate reviews.
- View important system activity through audit history.

- View platform-wide financial information.

6. Property and Category Structure

A property can contain multiple separate bookable categories/sub-listings. Each category has its own price and availability.

Property
↓
Category / Sub-listing
↓
Price
↓
Availability
↓
Booking

Example: one property may have Standard, Premium and Pool categories. A booking of one category does not automatically block another independent category.

7. Availability

Availability will be based on exact date and time ranges rather than only calendar dates. The guest should be able to understand availability without needing to interpret a complicated calendar.

- Calendar overview showing available, partially available and unavailable periods.
- Selected-day or timeline view showing actual occupied/open time ranges.
- Check-in date and time selector.
- Duration selector for 24, 48, 72 hours and so on.
- Immediate result showing whether the selected period is available.
- Clear messages such as: “Someone is staying from 25 Sep 2:00 PM until 26 Sep 2:00 PM.”
- The final design may combine calendar, timeline and direct availability-selection patterns.

8. Booking

1. Guest selects a property and category/sub-listing.
2. Guest selects a check-in date and time.
3. Guest selects a 24-hour multiple for the duration.

4. System checks availability.
5. Guest submits a booking request.
6. The requested time slot is temporarily held.
7. Host accepts or rejects the request.
8. If rejected or expired, the hold is released.
9. If accepted, the guest is asked to complete payment.
10. Successful payment confirms the booking and permanently blocks the exact booked time range.

9. Payments, Refunds and Host Payouts

Guest payments will be processed through Stripe. Host payouts will use Stripe Connect. NearBNB will keep the marketplace financial records and will not build its own bank-transfer mechanism.

Situation	MVP behavior
Guest payment	Guest pays after the host accepts the booking request.
Guest cancellation	System applies the cancellation policy, calculates the applicable refund and initiates the refund process.
Host cancellation	Booking is cancelled and the guest receives the applicable refund; the host cancellation is recorded.
Exceptional host refund	Host submits a refund request; platform/admin reviews and processes the approved refund.
Host payout	Host amount becomes eligible after a configurable period following check-in; initial recommendation is 24 hours.
Host financial visibility	Host can see transactions, earnings, refunds and payout information for their own properties.
Admin financial visibility	Admin can see platform-wide payments, refunds, transfers/payouts and related records.

10. Pricing, Fees and Taxes

The platform will support a transparent booking price and will keep the financial components separately. The exact tax treatment and rates depend on the applicable country/region and the platform's legal/tax setup.

- Accommodation amount.
- Applicable cleaning or property fees, if used.
- Guest/platform service fee, if used.
- Platform commission.
- Applicable taxes.
- Discounts or adjustments, if introduced.
- Final payable amount.
- Currency.

Australia is the initial launch market. The design will support country-specific currency, tax and fee configuration so additional countries can be introduced later.

11. Reviews

- Reviews are available after a booking is completed.
- The guest can review the host/property.
- The host can review the guest.
- Each party can submit one review per completed booking.
- Guest/property reviews can contribute to the public property rating.
- Guest trust information from host reviews is not intended to be publicly displayed like a property review; the final visibility rules will be controlled by the platform.
- Admins can moderate reviews.

12. Notifications

- Email verification.
- Password reset.
- Host application/approval updates.
- Property approval/rejection/changes requested.
- Booking request received.
- Booking accepted/rejected/expired.
- Payment success/failure.
- Booking confirmation.

- Cancellation and refund status.
- Upcoming check-in and checkout reminders.
- Review invitation.

13. Security and Trust

- Email verification for accounts.
- Host verification before host activation.
- Stripe-based payout onboarding for hosts.
- Role-based access for guest, host and admin.
- Sensitive financial and identity information is not exposed publicly.
- Admin actions affecting important records are recorded in audit history.
- Payment card details are handled by the payment provider rather than stored by NearBNB.

14. MVP Exclusions / Future Scope

- Native mobile applications.
- Complex dispute-management system.
- AI recommendations and dynamic pricing.
- Loyalty, referrals and affiliate programs.
- Promoted listings.
- Complex multi-property/group bookings.
- Group payments and split stays.
- Advanced guest-host in-app messaging unless added to the agreed MVP scope.
- Multiple-language and multi-currency user experience as an initial launch feature; the architecture will remain ready for expansion.

15. Client Decisions Required Before Development Freeze

- Maximum stay duration.
- Whether the 30-minute check-in interval should be changed to 15 or 60 minutes.
- Booking request expiry period.
- Host identity-verification method.
- Accepted guest social-verification fields/platforms, if required.
- Platform commission and guest service fee.
- Tax/legal treatment and tax responsibility for each launch jurisdiction.
- Host payout release delay; initial recommendation is 24 hours after check-in.
- Cancellation policy templates and refund treatment.

- Exact visibility rules for guest trust/review information.
- Final support/issue handling process.

16. Definition of MVP Completion

The MVP will be considered complete when a verified and approved host can create an approved bookable property/category, a guest can find an available time window, submit a booking request, receive host approval, complete payment, receive confirmation, complete the stay, and the platform can process the configured payout and review flows while administrators retain the required operational and financial visibility.